

Miniukovich & De Angeli: Computation of Interface Aesthetics

Verified reference summary • Year: 2015 • Source bibliography: docs/REFERENCES.md

What the paper contributes

Miniukovich and De Angeli define automatic GUI-aesthetics metrics across information amount, information organization, and information discriminability. Examples include clutter, color variability, symmetry, grid, grouping, contour density, and contrast.

Method / evaluation stance

The paper is useful because it distinguishes geometry/theme-computable measures from pixel-only measures. Symmetry, grid alignment, color variability, visual clutter, and whitespace can be approximated from slidekit source data. Contour density and figure-ground contrast need rendered pixels.

How slidekit uses it

slidekit's aesthetic scorer therefore covers the no-render subset and leaves pixel-only evaluation to future rendered checks or calibration studies. This keeps production scoring deterministic while preserving a path to richer research evaluation.

YAML vs HTML takeaway

The executive implication is hybrid: YAML should remain the source of truth for generation, validation, and fixes; HTML or rendered PDFs should be used only where the research metric genuinely needs pixels.

Bottom line

The paper supports a pragmatic split: use research-style rendered artifacts when the question depends on final pixels or human preference collection, but keep slidekit production decks in a constrained YAML IR so layout, linting, and agent fixes remain deterministic, inspectable, and cheap.

Primary slidekit mapping	balance / alignment / whitespace / overlap / contrast / richness / consistency, depending on the paper
Operational risk	HTML metrics can drift with rendering environment; YAML metrics can miss pixel-only effects. Use each where it is strongest.